Apart from Surface 3 support, the new Linux kernel version will come with some upgrades for new GPU models while offering various updates to support advanced architecture.

Attic Labs develops open source Noms database

Attic Labs has announced that it has developed the open source Noms database to deliver an experience similar to projects like Git and Camlistone. The San Francisco-based software company has raised US$ 1.8 million in a Series A round to maintain its decentralised database over the long run.

Noms can be replicated and edited concurrently on multiple computers. This feature makes it a unique offering in the world of database systems. Additionally, the database stores structured data instead of text files, and is designed to scale to massive data records.

"We think of a forkable, synchronisable database as an important primitive in our increasingly data-centric world," wrote Aaron Boodman, co-founder of Attic Labs, in a blog post. "It can be used to collaborate on large-scale structured data across organisations. It can be used as the basis for any decentralised application. And it can make a very good archive for most sorts of data," he added.

Boodman previously developed popular Firefox extension Greasemonkey and was a technical lead for Google Chrome. Apart from Boodman's development skills, Attic Labs has some other top-level management members who worked on open source developments like Chrome OS before releasing Noms.

Some of the primary features that could persuade you to leverage Noms for your next data-related operation include its easy aggregation and transformation of information, synchronisation of large datasets and fork as well as merging of workflow from an existing solution.

Greylock Partners, which previously backed Docker, led the funding round. Investors, including Harrison Metal, Naval Ravikant, Linus Upson and Othman Laraki, also helped in the development of the database.

Government to launch India's own open source collaboration platform

Months after rolling out a policy to support open source software development, the Indian government is now all set to launch its own collaboration platform for hosting open source projects. The move is apparently aimed at encouraging software developers and various government bodies to start sharing code from their major projects, under one roof.

The Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) released a policy related to the adoption of open source software in April 2015. Called 'Collaborative Application Development by Opening the Source Code of Government Applications', the policy aims to provide a comprehensive framework for archiving government source code in repositories. The framework

Linux 4.7 now out with enhanced security and advanced graphics support

A couple of months after bringing out the mobile-focused build, Finnish-American software engineer Linus Torvalds has now released Linux 4.7 as his newest Linux kernel. The new version enhances the security of Linux systems through a new module and supports some modern GPU models.

"After a slight delay due to my travels, I'm back, and 4.7 is out," Torvalds wrote in a note. "Despite it being two weeks since rc7, the final patch wasn't all that big, and much of it is trivial one- and few-liners. There's a couple of network drivers that got a bit more loving," he added.

Linux kernel 4.7 has a LoadPin security module that helps the platform load all the necessary modules from the same file system. It is ported directly from Google's Chrome OS and aims to limit the medium from which kernel modules and firmware load on a system.

Apart from the new security module, the latest Linux kernel has the CONFIG_TRIM_UNUSED_KSYMS option to remove exported kernel symbols that are unused on the system. This will reduce the size of the generated kernel binary and improve the overall user experience. Also, the reduction of exported kernel symbols would be a helpful move from the security perspective.

This kernel supports the newly launched Radeon RX 480 GPUs through the AMDGPU driver. Besides, the video driver has been upgraded with some performance improvements.

Continuing the trend of supporting more mobile devices in addition to desktops and notebooks, Linux 4.7 supports some new ARM platforms. There is native support for devices like the Google Pixel C and Amazon Kindle Fire. Torvalds has additionally provided a PMC driver for various Intel Core chipsets and support to generate virtual USB device controllers in USB/IP.

You can download Linux 4.7 on your system directly from the official kernel website.